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Localhost digital certificate discovery and reconciliation

Abstract

A computer implemented method is provided. A number of processor units identify a number of certificates for a device within a network to obtain a file path for each certificate. The number of processor units perform an internal scan of the device to obtain a port number for each active port associated with network protocol on the device. The number of processor units identify a certificate chain associated with each port number based on the network protocol for the device. The number of processor units compare content for each certificate from the number of certificates to the certificate chains for the device to generate a number of matches. The number of processor units generate a data structure including the file path of the certificate for each port on the device based on the number of matches.

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

(1) The disclosure relates generally to an improved computer system and more specifically to a computer implemented method, apparatus, system, and computer program product for matching a certificate to a port on a device within a network.

(2) Network security for verifying authenticity and identity are fundamental components of maintaining a secure and trustworthy digital environment. Specifically, verification of authenticity and identity are designed to ensure that entities communicating over the network are authentic as asserted.

(3) One method used in network security to verify authenticity is the implementation of certificates. Certificates are cryptographic documents that are issued by trusted Certificate Authorities and serve

as cryptographic proof of identity for an entity. The digital certificates contain several components. For example, certificates include public keys used for encryption and digital signatures. The certificate also includes an issuer's digital signature, generated using the private key from the Certificate Authorities. The digital signature serves as a seal of authenticity for verifying both the legitimacy of the certificate and endorsement from the Certificate Authorities for the entity's identity.

(4) In this case, entities exchange certificates for mutual authentication when they communicate over a network. This mutual authentication process confirms that the entities on both ends of the communication are legitimate and can be trusted. In addition, each digital certificate is granted a specific validity period. Once the validity period expires, the digital certificate needs to be renewed to maintain validity.

SUMMARY

(5) According to one illustrative embodiment, a computer implemented method for matching certificates with active ports on a device in a network is provided. A number of processor units identify a number of certificates for a device within a network to obtain a file path for each certificate. The number of processor units perform an internal scan of the device to obtain a port number for each active port associated with network protocol on the device. The number of processor units identify a certificate chain associated with each port number based on the network protocol for the device. The number of processor units compare content for each certificate from the number of certificates to the certificate chains for the device to generate a number of matches. The number of processor units generate a data structure including the file path of the certificate for each port on the device based on the number of matches. According to other illustrative embodiments, a computer system and a computer program product for predicting the next frame are provided.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is a block diagram of a computing environment in accordance with an illustrative embodiment;
- (2) FIG. 2 is a block diagram of a security management environment in accordance with an illustrative embodiment;
- (3) FIG. 3 is an illustration for identifying certificates for ports on a device using internal service and third-party service in accordance with an illustrative embodiment;
- (4) FIG. 4 is an illustration of a graphical user interface in accordance with an illustrative embodiment;
- (5) FIG. 5 is a dataflow for generating a data structure that includes mapping of certificates and active ports for devices in a network in accordance with an illustrative embodiment;
- (6) FIG. 6 is a flowchart of a process for matching certificates with ports on a device in accordance with an illustrative embodiment;
- (7) FIG. 7 is a flowchart of a process for comparing content of certificate to certificate chains in accordance with an illustrative embodiment;
- (8) FIG. 8 is a flowchart of a process for comparing content of certificate to certificate chains in accordance with an illustrative embodiment;
- (9) FIG. 9 is a flowchart of a process for mapping all active ports to file paths of certificates on a device in accordance with an illustrative embodiment;
- (10) FIG. 10 is a block diagram of a data processing system in accordance with an illustrative embodiment.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(11) According to one illustrative embodiment, a computer implemented method for matching certificates with active ports on a device in a network is provided. A number of processor units identify a number of certificates for a device within a network to obtain a file path for each certificate. The number of processor units perform an internal scan of the device to obtain a port number for each active port associated with network protocol on the device. The number of processor units identify a certificate chain associated with each port number based on the network protocol for the device. The number of processor units compare content for each certificate from the number of certificates to the certificate chains for the device to generate a number of matches. The number of processor units generate a data structure including the file path of the certificate for each port on the device based on the number of matches. As a result, the illustrative embodiments provide a technical effect of accurately matching certificates to ports on a device within a network without third-party access.

(12) In the illustrative embodiments, as part of identifying a number of certificates for a device within a network to obtain a file path for each certificate, the number of certificates for the device within the network is identified based on file extensions. As a result, the illustrative embodiments provide a technical effect of efficiently identifying certificate with predefined classifications to improve accuracy.

(13) In the illustrative embodiments, the number of processor units perform the identification of certificates and internal scan of the device concurrently. As a result, the illustrative embodiments provide a technical effect of running processes in parallel to reduce computing time.

(14) In the illustrative embodiments, as part of comparing content for each certificate from the number of certificates to the certificate chain for the device to generate a number of matches, the number of processor units further select a certificate from the number of certificates. The number of processor units compare blocks from the content of the selected certificate to blocks from content of the certificate chain for each port on the device. The number of processor units determine whether the content of the selected certificate and the content of the certificate chain for each port on the device originated from same certificate. As a result, the illustrative embodiments provide a technical effect of matching content of certificates obtained from two different sources to accurately matching a certificate to a port on the device within a network.

(15) In the illustrative embodiments, as a part of comparing content for each certificate from the number of certificates to the certificate chain for the device to generate a number of matches, the number of processor units further compare first lines in the blocks from the content of the selected certificate to first lines in the blocks from the content of the certificate chain for each port on the device. As a result, the illustrative embodiments provide a technical effect of only comparing the first line in the blocks from the contents of certificates to reduce computing time.

(16) In the illustrative embodiments, the number of processor units further repeat identifying the number of certificates, performing the internal scan, identifying certificate chain associated with each port number, comparing content for each certificate from the number of certificates to the certificate chain for the device to generate a number of matches, and generating the data structure until all active ports on the device are mapped to the file paths of certificates. As a result, the illustrative embodiments provide a technical effect of efficiently providing comprehensive security information related all to ports on the devices.

(17) In the illustrative embodiments, as part of generating a data structure including the file path of the certificate for each port on the device based on the number of matches, the data structure can also include metadata associated with the certificates based the number of matches. As a result, the illustrative embodiments provide a technical effect of storing all important security information related to the certificates, which is properly formatted such that all information can be retrieved from a single source in the future.

(18) According to one illustrative embodiment, a computer system comprises a number of processor units. The number of processor units execute program instructions to identify a number

of certificates for a device within a network to obtain a file path for each certificate. The number of processor units execute program instructions to perform an internal scan of the device to obtain a port number for each active port associated with network protocol on the device. The number of processor units execute program instructions to identify a certificate chain associated with each port number based on the network protocol for the device. The number of processor units execute program instructions to compare content for each certificate from the number of certificates to the certificate chains for the device to generate a number of matches. The number of processor units execute program instructions to generate a data structure including the file path of the certificate for each port on the device based on the number of matches. As a result, the illustrative embodiments provide a technical effect of accurately matching certificates to ports on a device within a network without third-party access.

(19) In the illustrative embodiments, as part of identifying a number of certificates for a device within a network to obtain a file path for each certificate, the number of certificates for the device within the network is identified based on file extensions. As a result, the illustrative embodiments provide a technical effect of efficiently identifying certificate with predefined classifications to improve accuracy.

(20) In the illustrative embodiments, the number of processor units execute program instructions to perform the identification of certificates and internal scan of the device concurrently. As a result, the illustrative embodiments provide a technical effect of running processes in parallel to reduce computing time.

(21) In the illustrative embodiments, as part of comparing content for each certificate from the number of certificates to the certificate chain for the device to generate a number of matches, the number of processor units can further execute program instructions to select a certificate from the number of certificates. The number of processor units can further execute program instructions to compare blocks from the content of the selected certificate to blocks from content of the certificate chain for each port on the device. The number of processor units can further execute program instructions to determine whether the content of the selected certificate and the content of the certificate chain for each port on the device originated from same certificate. As a result, the illustrative embodiments provide a technical effect of matching content of certificates obtained from two different sources to accurately matching a certificate to a port on the device within a network.

(22) In the illustrative embodiments, as a part of comparing content for each certificate from the number of certificates to the certificate chain for the device to generate a number of matches, the number of processor units can further execute program instructions to compare first lines in the blocks from the content of the selected certificate to first lines in the blocks from the content of the certificate chain for each port on the device. As a result, the illustrative embodiments provide a technical effect of only comparing the first line in the blocks from the contents of certificates to reduce computing time.

(23) In the illustrative embodiments, the number of processor units can further execute program instructions to repeat identifying the number of certificates, performing the internal scan, identifying certificate chain associated with each port number, comparing content for each certificate from the number of certificates to the certificate chain for the device to generate a number of matches, and generating the data structure until all active ports on the device are mapped to the file paths of certificates. As a result, the illustrative embodiments provide a technical effect of efficiently providing comprehensive security information related all to ports on the devices.

(24) In the illustrative embodiments, as part of generating a data structure including the file path of the certificate for each port on the device based on the number of matches, the data structure can also include metadata associated with the certificates based the number of matches. As a result, the illustrative embodiments provide a technical effect of storing all important security information related to the certificates, which is properly formatted such that all information can be retrieved

from a single source in the future.

(25) According to one illustrative embodiment, a computer program product for matching certificates with active ports on a device in a network is provided. The computer program product includes a computer readable storage medium having program instructions embodied therewith. The program instructions executable by a computer system to cause the computer system to identify a number of certificates for a device within a network to obtain a file path for each certificate. The program instructions executable by the computer system to cause the computer system to perform an internal scan of the device to obtain a port number for each active port associated with network protocol on the device. The program instructions executable by the computer system to identify a certificate chain associated with each port number based on the network protocol for the device. The program instructions executable by the computer system to cause the computer system to compare content for each certificate from the number of certificates to the certificate chains for the device to generate a number of matches. The program instructions executable by the computer system to cause the computer system to generate a data structure including the file path of the certificate for each port on the device based on the number of matches. As a result, the illustrative embodiments provide a technical effect of accurately matching certificates to ports on a device within a network without third-party access.

(26) In the illustrative embodiments, as part of identifying a number of certificates for a device within a network to obtain a file path for each certificate, the number of certificates for the device within the network is identified based on file extensions. As a result, the illustrative embodiments provide a technical effect of efficiently identifying certificate with predefined classifications to improve accuracy.

(27) In the illustrative embodiments, the program instructions can be executable by the computer system to cause the computer system to perform the identification of certificates and internal scan of the device concurrently. As a result, the illustrative embodiments provide a technical effect of running processes in parallel to reduce computing time.

(28) In the illustrative embodiments, as part of comparing content for each certificate from the number of certificates to the certificate chain for the device to generate a number of matches, the program instructions can be further executable by the computer system to further cause the computer system to select a certificate from the number of certificates. The program instructions can be further executable by the computer system to further cause the computer system to compare blocks from the content of the selected certificate to blocks from content of the certificate chain for each port on the device. The program instructions can be further executable by the computer system to further cause the computer system to determine whether the content of the selected certificate and the content of the certificate chain for each port on the device originated from same certificate. As a result, the illustrative embodiments provide a technical effect of matching content of certificates obtained from two different sources to accurately matching a certificate to a port on the device within a network.

(29) In the illustrative embodiments, as a part of comparing content for each certificate from the number of certificates to the certificate chain for the device to generate a number of matches, the program instructions can be further executable by the computer system to further cause the computer system to compare first lines in the blocks from the content of the selected certificate to first lines in the blocks from the content of the certificate chain for each port on the device. As a result, the illustrative embodiments provide a technical effect of only comparing the first line in the blocks from the contents of certificates to reduce computing time.

(30) In the illustrative embodiments, the program instructions can be further executable by the computer system to further cause the computer system to repeat identifying the number of certificates, performing the internal scan, identifying certificate chain associated with each port number, comparing content for each certificate from the number of certificates to the certificate chain for the device to generate a number of matches, and generating the data structure until all

active ports on the device are mapped to the file paths of certificates. As a result, the illustrative embodiments provide a technical effect of efficiently providing comprehensive security information related all to ports on the devices.

(31) Various aspects of the present disclosure are described by narrative text, flowcharts, block diagrams of computer systems and/or block diagrams of the machine logic included in computer program product (CPP) embodiments. With respect to any flowcharts, depending upon the technology involved, the operations can be performed in a different order than what is shown in a given flowchart. For example, again depending upon the technology involved, two operations shown in successive flowchart blocks may be performed in reverse order, as a single integrated step, concurrently, or in a manner at least partially overlapping in time.

(32) A computer program product embodiment (“CPP embodiment” or “CPP”) is a term used in the present disclosure to describe any set of one, or more, storage media (also called “mediums”) collectively included in a set of one, or more, storage devices that collectively include machine readable code corresponding to instructions and/or data for performing computer operations specified in a given CPP claim. A “storage device” is any tangible device that can retain and store instructions for use by a computer processor. Without limitation, the computer readable storage medium may be an electronic storage medium, a magnetic storage medium, an optical storage medium, an electromagnetic storage medium, a semiconductor storage medium, a mechanical storage medium, or any suitable combination of the foregoing. Some known types of storage devices that include these mediums include: diskette, hard disk, random access memory (RAM), read-only memory (ROM), erasable programmable read-only memory (EPROM or Flash memory), static random access memory (SRAM), compact disc read-only memory (CD-ROM), digital versatile disk (DVD), memory stick, floppy disk, mechanically encoded device (such as punch cards or pits/lands formed in a major surface of a disc) or any suitable combination of the foregoing. A computer readable storage medium, as that term is used in the present disclosure, is not to be construed as storage in the form of transitory signals per se, such as radio waves or other freely propagating electromagnetic waves, electromagnetic waves propagating through a waveguide, light pulses passing through a fiber optic cable, electrical signals communicated through a wire, and/or other transmission media. As will be understood by those of skill in the art, data is typically moved at some occasional points in time during normal operations of a storage device, such as during access, de-fragmentation or garbage collection, but this does not render the storage device as transitory because the data is not transitory while it is stored.

(33) With reference now to the figures in particular with reference to FIG. 1, a block diagram of a computing environment is depicted in accordance with an illustrative embodiment. Computing environment **100** contains an example of an environment for the execution of at least some of the computer code involved in performing the inventive methods, such as security manager **190**. In this example, security manager **190** can operate to manage at least one of the creation or optimization of machine learning models. In the different illustrative examples, security manager **190** can operate to apply regression models into an optimization process for data driven model optimization.

(34) In addition to security manager **190**, computing environment **100** includes, for example, computer **101**, wide area network (WAN) **102**; end user device (EUD) **103**, remote server **104**, public cloud **105**, and private cloud **106**. In this embodiment, computer **101** includes processor set **110** (including processing circuitry **120** and cache **121**), communication fabric **111**, volatile memory **112**, persistent storage **113** (including operating system **122** and security manager **190**, as identified above), peripheral device set **114** (including user interface (UI) device set **123**, storage **124**, and Internet of Things (IoT) sensor set **125**), and network module **115**. Remote server **104** includes remote database **130**. Public cloud **105** includes gateway **140**, cloud orchestration module **141**, host physical machine set **142**, virtual machine set **143**, and container set **144**.

(35) COMPUTER **101** may take the form of a desktop computer, laptop computer, tablet computer, smart phone, smart watch or other wearable computer, mainframe computer, quantum computer or

any other form of computer or mobile device now known or to be developed in the future that is capable of running a program, accessing a network or querying a database, such as remote database **130**. As is well understood in the art of computer technology, and depending upon the technology, performance of a computer-implemented method may be distributed among multiple computers and/or between multiple locations. On the other hand, in this presentation of computing environment **100**, detailed discussion is focused on a single computer, specifically computer **101**, to keep the presentation as simple as possible. Computer **101** may be located in a cloud, even though it is not shown in a cloud in FIG. **1**. On the other hand, computer **101** is not required to be in a cloud except to any extent as may be affirmatively indicated.

(36) PROCESSOR SET **110** includes one, or more, computer processors of any type now known or to be developed in the future. Processing circuitry **120** may be distributed over multiple packages, for example, multiple, coordinated integrated circuit chips. Processing circuitry **120** may implement multiple processor threads and/or multiple processor cores. Cache **121** is memory that is located in the processor chip package(s) and is typically used for data or code that should be available for rapid access by the threads or cores running on processor set **110**. Cache memories are typically organized into multiple levels depending upon relative proximity to the processing circuitry. Alternatively, some, or all, of the cache for the processor set may be located “off chip.” In some computing environments, processor set **110** may be designed for working with qubits and performing quantum computing.

(37) Computer readable program instructions are typically loaded onto computer **101** to cause a series of operational steps to be performed by processor set **110** of computer **101** and thereby effect a computer-implemented method, such that the instructions thus executed will instantiate the methods specified in flowcharts and/or narrative descriptions of computer-implemented methods included in this document (collectively referred to as “the inventive methods”). These computer readable program instructions are stored in various types of computer readable storage media, such as cache **121** and the other storage media discussed below. The program instructions, and associated data, are accessed by processor set **110** to control and direct performance of the inventive methods. In computing environment **100**, at least some of the instructions for performing the inventive methods may be stored in security manager **190** in persistent storage **113**.

(38) COMMUNICATION FABRIC **111** is the signal conduction path that allows the various components of computer **101** to communicate with each other. Typically, this fabric is made of switches and electrically conductive paths, such as the switches and electrically conductive paths that make up busses, bridges, physical input/output ports and the like. Other types of signal communication paths may be used, such as fiber optic communication paths and/or wireless communication paths.

(39) VOLATILE MEMORY **112** is any type of volatile memory now known or to be developed in the future. Examples include dynamic type random access memory (RAM) or static type RAM. Typically, volatile memory **112** is characterized by random access, but this is not required unless affirmatively indicated. In computer **101**, the volatile memory **112** is located in a single package and is internal to computer **101**, but, alternatively or additionally, the volatile memory may be distributed over multiple packages and/or located externally with respect to computer **101**.

(40) PERSISTENT STORAGE **113** is any form of non-volatile storage for computers that is now known or to be developed in the future. The non-volatility of this storage means that the stored data is maintained regardless of whether power is being supplied to computer **101** and/or directly to persistent storage **113**. Persistent storage **113** may be a read only memory (ROM), but typically at least a portion of the persistent storage allows writing of data, deletion of data and re-writing of data. Some familiar forms of persistent storage include magnetic disks and solid-state storage devices. Operating system **122** may take several forms, such as various known proprietary operating systems or open-source Portable Operating System Interface-type operating systems that employ a kernel. The code included in security manager **190** includes at least some of the computer

code involved in performing the inventive methods.

(41) **PERIPHERAL DEVICE SET 114** includes the set of peripheral devices of computer **101**. Data communication connections between the peripheral devices and the other components of computer **101** may be implemented in various ways, such as Bluetooth connections, Near-Field Communication (NFC) connections, connections made by cables (such as universal serial bus (USB) type cables), insertion-type connections (for example, secure digital (SD) card), connections made through local area communication networks and even connections made through wide area networks such as the internet. In various embodiments, UI device set **123** may include components such as a display screen, speaker, microphone, wearable devices (such as goggles and smart watches), keyboard, mouse, printer, touchpad, game controllers, and haptic devices. Storage **124** is external storage, such as an external hard drive, or insertable storage, such as an SD card. Storage **124** may be persistent and/or volatile. In some embodiments, storage **124** may take the form of a quantum computing storage device for storing data in the form of qubits. In embodiments where computer **101** is required to have a large amount of storage (for example, where computer **101** locally stores and manages a large database) then this storage may be provided by peripheral storage devices designed for storing very large amounts of data, such as a storage area network (SAN) that is shared by multiple, geographically distributed computers. IoT sensor set **125** is made up of sensors that can be used in Internet of Things applications. For example, one sensor may be a thermometer and another sensor may be a motion detector.

(42) **NETWORK MODULE 115** is the collection of computer software, hardware, and firmware that allows computer **101** to communicate with other computers through WAN **102**. Network module **115** may include hardware, such as modems or Wi-Fi signal transceivers, software for packetizing and/or de-packetizing data for communication network transmission, and/or web browser software for communicating data over the internet. In some embodiments, network control functions and network forwarding functions of network module **115** are performed on the same physical hardware device. In other embodiments (for example, embodiments that utilize software-defined networking (SDN)), the control functions and the forwarding functions of network module **115** are performed on physically separate devices, such that the control functions manage several different network hardware devices. Computer readable program instructions for performing the inventive methods can typically be downloaded to computer **101** from an external computer or external storage device through a network adapter card or network interface included in network module **115**.

(43) **WAN 102** is any wide area network (for example, the internet) capable of communicating computer data over non-local distances by any technology for communicating computer data, now known or to be developed in the future. In some embodiments, the WAN **102** may be replaced and/or supplemented by local area networks (LANs) designed to communicate data between devices located in a local area, such as a Wi-Fi network. The WAN and/or LANs typically include computer hardware such as copper transmission cables, optical transmission fibers, wireless transmission, routers, firewalls, switches, gateway computers and edge servers.

(44) **END USER DEVICE (EUD) 103** is any computer system that is used and controlled by an end user (for example, a customer of an enterprise that operates computer **101**) and may take any of the forms discussed above in connection with computer **101**. EUD **103** typically receives helpful and useful data from the operations of computer **101**. For example, in a hypothetical case where computer **101** is designed to provide a recommendation to an end user, this recommendation would typically be communicated from network module **115** of computer **101** through WAN **102** to EUD **103**. In this way, EUD **103** can display, or otherwise present, the recommendation to an end user. In some embodiments, EUD **103** may be a client device, such as thin client, heavy client, mainframe computer, desktop computer and so on.

(45) **REMOTE SERVER 104** is any computer system that serves at least some data and/or functionality to computer **101**. Remote server **104** may be controlled and used by the same entity

that operates computer **101**. Remote server **104** represents the machine(s) that collect and store helpful and useful data for use by other computers, such as computer **101**. For example, in a hypothetical case where computer **101** is designed and programmed to provide a recommendation based on historical data, then this historical data may be provided to computer **101** from remote database **130** of remote server **104**.

(46) PUBLIC CLOUD **105** is any computer system available for use by multiple entities that provides on-demand availability of computer system resources and/or other computer capabilities, especially data storage (cloud storage) and computing power, without direct active management by the user. Cloud computing typically leverages sharing of resources to achieve coherence and economies of scale. The direct and active management of the computing resources of public cloud **105** is performed by the computer hardware and/or software of cloud orchestration module **141**. The computing resources provided by public cloud **105** are typically implemented by virtual computing environments that run on various computers making up the computers of host physical machine set **142**, which is the universe of physical computers in and/or available to public cloud **105**. The virtual computing environments (VCEs) typically take the form of virtual machines from virtual machine set **143** and/or containers from container set **144**. It is understood that these VCEs may be stored as images and may be transferred among and between the various physical machine hosts, either as images or after instantiation of the VCE. Cloud orchestration module **141** manages the transfer and storage of images, deploys new instantiations of VCEs and manages active instantiations of VCE deployments. Gateway **140** is the collection of computer software, hardware, and firmware that allows public cloud **105** to communicate through WAN **102**.

(47) Some further explanation of virtualized computing environments (VCEs) will now be provided. VCEs can be stored as “images.” A new active instance of the VCE can be instantiated from the image. Two familiar types of VCEs are virtual machines and containers. A container is a VCE that uses operating-system-level virtualization. This refers to an operating system feature in which the kernel allows the existence of multiple isolated user-space instances, called containers. These isolated user-space instances typically behave as real computers from the point of view of programs running in them. A computer program running on an ordinary operating system can utilize all resources of that computer, such as connected devices, files and folders, network shares, CPU power, and quantifiable hardware capabilities. However, programs running inside a container can only use the contents of the container and devices assigned to the container, a feature which is known as containerization.

(48) PRIVATE CLOUD **106** is similar to public cloud **105**, except that the computing resources are only available for use by a single enterprise. While private cloud **106** is depicted as being in communication with WAN **102**, in other embodiments a private cloud may be disconnected from the internet entirely and only accessible through a local/private network. A hybrid cloud is a composition of multiple clouds of different types (for example, private, community or public cloud types), often respectively implemented by different vendors. Each of the multiple clouds remains a separate and discrete entity, but the larger hybrid cloud architecture is bound together by standardized or proprietary technology that enables orchestration, management, and/or data/application portability between the multiple constituent clouds. In this embodiment, public cloud **105** and private cloud **106** are both part of a larger hybrid cloud.

(49) The illustrative embodiments recognize and take into account a number of different considerations as described herein. For example, the illustrative embodiments recognize and take into account that digital certificates are important for security and integrity of intranet and internet applications. In other words, monitoring and maintenance of digital certificates are crucial for operational efficiency, security, and compliance for an enterprise.

(50) Additionally, the illustrative embodiments recognize and take into account that it is troublesome to collate and track data related to digital certificates. The illustrative embodiments also recognize and take into account that third-party services need multiple accesses to perform

external scan ports on a device and cannot locate actual files associated with the complete certificate chain for scanned ports.

(51) The illustrative embodiments also recognize and take account that scan ports on a device internally can provide more comprehensive detail related to active certificates and active ports compared to external tools. The illustrative examples provide a computer implemented method, apparatus, computer system, and computer program product for matching certificates with ports on a device in a network.

(52) In an illustrative example, certificates for a device within a network are identified to obtain a file path for each certificate. An internal scan of the device is performed to obtain a port number for each active port associated with network protocol on the device. A certificate chain associated with each port number is identified based on the network protocol for the device. Content for each certificate from the certificates to the certificate chains for the device is compared to generate matches. A data structure including the file path of the certificate for each port on the device is generated based on the matches.

(53) In another illustrative example, the internal scan and identification of the number of certificates are performed concurrently. In yet another illustrative example, a certificate from the number of certificates is selected. Blocks from the content of the selected certificate are compared to blocks from content of the certificate chain for each port on the device. Whether the content of the selected certificate and the content of the certificate chain for each port on the device originated from same certificate is determined based on the comparison.

(54) With reference now to FIG. 2, a block diagram of a security management environment is depicted in accordance with an illustrative embodiment. In this illustrative example, security management environment **200** includes components that can be implemented in computing environment **100** in FIG. 1.

(55) In this illustrative example, security management system **202** in security management environment **200** can be used to generate data structure **222** based on matches **216** by comparing content **230** from certificate chain **228** with content **246** from certificate **238**. In this example, data structure **222** can be used for managing at least one of a process or a system.

(56) Security management system **202** comprises a number of different components. As depicted, security management system **202** comprises computer system **204** and security manager **214**. Security manager **214** is located in computer system **204**.

(57) Security manager **214** can be implemented in software, hardware, firmware, or a combination thereof. When software is used, the operations performed by security manager **214** can be implemented in program instructions configured to run on hardware, such as a processor unit. When firmware is used, the operations performed by security manager **214** can be implemented in program instructions and data and stored in persistent memory to run on a processor unit. When hardware is employed, the hardware can include circuits that operate to perform the operations in security manager **214**.

(58) In the illustrative examples, the hardware can take a form selected from at least one of a circuit system, an integrated circuit, an application specific integrated circuit (ASIC), a programmable logic device, or some other suitable type of hardware configured to perform a number of operations. With a programmable logic device, the device can be configured to perform the number of operations. The device can be reconfigured at a later time or can be permanently configured to perform the number of operations. Programmable logic devices include, for example, a programmable logic array, a programmable array logic, a field programmable logic array, a field programmable gate array, and other suitable hardware devices. Additionally, the processes can be implemented in organic components integrated with inorganic components and can be comprised entirely of organic components excluding a human being. For example, the processes can be implemented as circuits in organic semiconductors.

(59) As used herein, “a number of” when used with reference to items, means one or more items.

For example, “a number of operations” is one or more operations.

(60) Further, the phrase “at least one of,” when used with a list of items, means different combinations of one or more of the listed items can be used, and only one of each item in the list may be needed. In other words, “at least one of” means any combination of items and number of items may be used from the list, but not all of the items in the list are required. The item can be a particular object, a thing, or a category.

(61) For example, without limitation, “at least one of item A, item B, or item C” may include item A, item A and item B, or item B. This example also may include item A, item B, and item C or item B and item C. Of course, any combination of these items can be present. In some illustrative examples, “at least one of” can be, for example, without limitation, two of item A; one of item B; and ten of item C; four of item B and seven of item C; or other suitable combinations.

(62) Computer system **204** is a physical hardware system and includes one or more data processing systems. When more than one data processing system is present in computer system **204**, those data processing systems are in communication with each other using a communications medium. The communications medium can be a network. The data processing systems can be selected from at least one of a computer, a server computer, a tablet computer, or some other suitable data processing system.

(63) As depicted, computer system **204** includes a number of processor units **208** that are capable of executing program instructions **210** implementing processes in the illustrative examples. In other words, program instructions **210** are computer readable program instructions.

(64) As used herein, a processor unit in the number of processor units **208** is a hardware device and is comprised of hardware circuits such as those on an integrated circuit that respond to and process instructions and program instructions that operate a computer. A processor unit can be implemented using processor set **110** in FIG. 1. When the number of processor units **208** executes program instructions **210** for a process, the number of processor units **208** can be one or more processor units that are in the same computer or in different computers. In other words, the process can be distributed between processor units **208** on the same or different computers in computer system **204**.

(65) Further, the number of processor units **208** can be of the same type or different type of processor units. For example, the number of processor units **208** can be selected from at least one of a single core processor, a dual-core processor, a multi-core processor, a general-purpose central processing unit (CPU), a graphics processing unit (GPU), a digital signal processor (DSP), or some other type of processor unit.

(66) Computer system **204** further includes machine intelligence **212**. Machine intelligence **212** comprises machine learning **232** and machine learning algorithms **234**. Machine learning **232** is a branch of artificial intelligence (AI) that enables computers to detect patterns and improve performance without direct programming commands. Rather than relying on direct input commands to complete a task, machine learning **232** relies on input-data. The data is fed into the machine, one of machine learning algorithms **234** is selected, parameters for the data are configured, and the machine is instructed to find patterns in the input data through optimization algorithms. The data model formed from analyzing the data is then used to predict future values. In this illustrative example, the learning of the security manager **214** can be achieved through a database input that is continuously refined over time through trial and error. Equivalence of assets or products can be effectively performed by supervised machine learning so that products or assets that do not match descriptively can nevertheless be matched. Over time, the data model from machine learning can provide a greater degree of flexibility in matching for the security manager **214**.

(67) Machine intelligence **212** can be implemented using one or more systems such as an artificial intelligence system, a neural network, a Bayesian network, an expert system, a fuzzy logic system, a genetic algorithm, or other suitable types of systems. Machine learning **232** and machine learning

algorithms **234** may make computer system **204** a special purpose computer for dynamic predictive modelling for processing data records.

(68) Machine learning **232** involves using machine learning algorithms **234** to build machine learning models based on samples of data. The samples of data used for training referred to as training data or training datasets. Machine learning models trained using training datasets and make predictions without being explicitly programmed to make these predictions. Machine learning models can be trained and retrained for a number of different types of applications. These applications include, for example, medicine, healthcare, speech recognition, computer vision, or other types of applications. In this example, the outputs from machine learning model can be used to retrain the machine learning algorithm **234** to make better predictions and forecasts.

(69) Machine learning algorithms **234** can include supervised machine learning algorithms and unsupervised machine learning algorithms. Supervised machine learning can train machine learning models using data containing both the inputs and desired outputs. Examples of machine learning algorithms include gradient boosting, K-means clustering, and random forest.

(70) In this illustrative example, device **224** is a data processing system running in computer system **204**. For example, device **224** can be a physical machine, a virtual machine, or any data processing system that is capable of collecting, processing, storing and outputting data. Device **224** includes a number of ports **240** that serve as logical endpoints or communication channels for sending and receiving data with other devices or applications within network **226**.

(71) In this illustrative example, network **226** refers to a collection of interconnected devices and communication infrastructure that allows device **224** and other interconnected devices to communicate, share resources, and exchange data with one another. Network protocol **242** is a communication protocol for network **226**. In this example, network **226** relies on network protocol **242** to define rules and standards for how data should be formatted, transmitted, received, and interpreted. For example, network protocol **242** can be Secure Sockets Layer/Transport Layer Security (SSL/TLS) protocol.

(72) Ports **240** include a number of active ports such as active port **250** that are currently in use and actively communicating with other devices within network **226**. Each active port is associated with a port number used to identify network services and applications. In this illustrative example, port numbers for active ports from ports **240** can be identified by performing internal port scan **256**. Internal port scan **256** is a security assessment technique used to identify active ports and services running on device **224**. In this illustrative example, internal port scan **256** is conducted from within network **226** to evaluate security for device **224**. For example, security manager **214** can perform internal port scan **256** using Nmap, Netcat, Hping, Masscan, Zmap, or any other tools or software that can be used to discover active ports on a device or network. In this illustrative example, security manager **214** can perform internal port scan **256** to identify port number **254** for active port **250**.

(73) In this illustrative example, security manager **214** can identify a number of certificates **218** for device **224**. In this illustrative example, certificates **218** are digital documents that are issued by a trusted certificate authority and serve as cryptographic proof of identities for entities. Certificates **218** can be used for secure communications according to network protocol **242** from network **226**.

(74) Each certificate in certificates **218** includes content and a file path. For example, certificate **238** in certificates **218** includes content **246** and file path **248**. Content **246** includes a number of blocks **252** that contains fingerprints of certificate **238**. In this illustrative example, fingerprints of certificate **238** in blocks **252** are representations of content **246** and can be a hexadecimal string generated by applying a cryptographic hash function to certificate **238**. In this illustrative example, the cryptographic hash function can take binary data from certificate **238** and produce a hexadecimal string that is unique to the input binary data. Fingerprints of certificate **238** in blocks **252** serve as unique identifiers for certificate **238** and can be used for various purposes such as certificate validation and comparison.

(75) As depicted, certificate **238** also includes file path **248** that refers to the file location or directory where certificate **238** is stored. File path **248** provides the address and route to access certificate **238**.

(76) File extensions **236** are certificate formats for certificates in certificates **218**. For example, file extensions **236** can be .crt, .pem, .cer, .der, .key, or any other formats that can be used to identify type of data contained in certificates. In this illustrative example, security manager **214** can identify certificates **218** based on file extensions **236**.

(77) In this illustrative example, metadata **220** is information associated with certificates **218**. Metadata **220** provides context and detail related to certificates in certificates **218**. For example, metadata **220** can include version, serial number, signature, signature algorithm, issuer, validity period, subject, and any suitable information related to certificates in certificates **218**.

(78) In addition, security manager **214** can also identify a number of certificate chains **206**. Each certificate chain in certificate chains **206** is a hierarchical structure of digital certificates that establishes the trustworthiness of digital certificates for entities such as a websites or individuals. As depicted, certificate chain **228** is one of the certificate chains in certificate chains **206**.

(79) In this illustrative example, content **230** in certificate chain **228** contains multiple digital certificates arranged in a hierarchical manner. For example, content **230** can include root certificates, intermediate certificates, and end-entity certificates for certificate chain **228**. Root certificates are at the top of the hierarchy and are self-signed certificates that belong to the trusted certificate authorities. Intermediate certificates are signed by root certificates and are used to fill the gap between root certificates and end-entity certificates. End-entity certificates are certificates signed by intermediate certificates and used by entities such as device **224**. In this example, root certificates, intermediate certificates, and end-entity certificates create hierarchies that establish chains of trust.

(80) As depicted, content **230** includes a number of blocks **244** that contains fingerprints of certificates in certificate chain **228**. In a similar fashion, fingerprints in blocks **244** can be hexadecimal string generated by applying a cryptographic hash function to certificates in certificate chain **228**. In this illustrative example, the cryptographic hash function can take binary data from certificates in certificate chain **228** and produces hexadecimal strings that are unique to the input binary data. Fingerprints in blocks **244** serve as unique identifiers for certificates in certificate chain **228** and can be used for various purposes such as certificate validation and comparison as described above.

(81) In this illustrative example, each certificate chain in certificate chains **206** is associated with a port number for an active port from ports **240** in device **224**. For example, certificate chain **228** in certificate chains **206** is associated with port number **254** for active port **250**. In this example, security manager **214** can identify certificate chain **228** for active port **250** based on network protocol **242**. For example, if network protocol **242** is Secure Sockets Layer/Transport Layer Security (SSL/TLS) protocol, security manager **214** can use “-showcerts” option or equivalent in OpenSSL toolkit to retrieve a complete certificate chain for any active port on a device that is making a connection using SSL/TLS protocol.

(82) In this illustrative example, security manager **214** generates a number of matches **216** from comparing contents from certificate chains **206** to contents from certificates **218** to determine whether content of any certificate in certificates chains **206** is originated from the same certificate as a certificate from certificates **218**.

(83) For example, security manager **214** can compare content **230** for certificate chain **228** to content **246** for certificate **238** to determine whether certificate **238** matches with any certificate from certificate chain **228**. In other words, security manager **214** can determine whether certificate **238** is also a certificate present in, or encompass the whole of, certificate chain **228** by comparing fingerprints in blocks **244** to fingerprints in blocks **252**. In this example, security manager **214** can compare the first line in each block from blocks **244** to the first line in each block from blocks **252**

to improve computing efficiency.

(84) Security manager **214** can further generate data structure **222** based on matches **216**. As depicted, each match in matches **216** indicates that a certificate in certificates **218** is also present in a certificate chain in certificate chains **206**. In other words, security manager **214** can match the file path of a certificate in certificates **218** to a port number since certificate chains in certificate chains **206** are associated with a port number according to network protocol **242**.

(85) For example, a match in matches **216** can be created for content **246** and content **230**. In this example, the match indicates that certificate **238** is a certificate present in certificate chain **228**. In other words, file path **248** for certificate **238** can be associated with port number **254** such that active port **250** is mapped to certificate chain **228** and file path **248** for certificate **238**. In this illustrative example, data structure **222** can include port number **254** and file path **248** for the match between content **230** and content **246**.

(86) In addition, data structure **222** can also include other information such as metadata **220** for certificates **218** based on matches **216**. As depicted, metadata **220** can include version, serial number, signature, signature algorithm, issuer, validity period, subject, and any suitable information related to certificates in certificates **238**. By including metadata **220**, data structure **222** can provide a comprehensive detail related to certificates **218** and certificate chains **206** for future display and analysis.

(87) In an alternative example, security manager **214** can perform matching for device **224** until all active ports in ports **240** are mapped to a file path of a certificate in certificates **218** and a certificate chain in certificate chains **206**.

(88) In one illustrative example, one or more solutions are present that overcome a problem with generating an optimization solution for managing computer components for processing requests. As a result, one or more solutions provide an effect of increasing efficiency of the principal database by diverting a portion of requests that can be processed by other applications.

(89) Computer system **204** can be configured to perform at least one of the steps, operations, or actions described in the different illustrative examples using software, hardware, firmware, or a combination thereof. As a result, computer system **204** operates as a special purpose computer system in which security manager **214** in computer system **204** enables mapping of active ports to certificate chains and file paths of certificates in the certificate chains without using third-party services. In particular, security manager **214** transforms computer system **204** into a special purpose computer system as compared to currently available general computer systems that do not have security manager **214**.

(90) The illustration of security management environment **200** in FIG. 2 is not meant to imply physical or architectural limitations to the manner in which an illustrative embodiment can be implemented. For example, security management environment **200** can also perform functionalities described above for other devices running in computer system **204** until each active ports for devices running in computer system **204** are mapped to a certificate and complete certificate chain. Further, other components in addition to or in place of the ones illustrated may be used. Some components may be unnecessary. Also, the blocks are presented to illustrate some functional components. One or more of these blocks may be combined, divided, or combined and divided into different blocks when implemented in an illustrative embodiment.

(91) It should also be appreciated that while the illustrative embodiments will be described herein with reference to SSL/TLS as an example network protocol with which the mechanisms of the illustrative embodiments are utilized, the illustrative embodiments are not limited to such. To the contrary, the illustrative embodiments may be implemented and operate with any currently known or later developed network protocol without departing from the spirit and scope of the present invention.

(92) With reference now to FIG. 3, an illustration for identifying certificates for ports on a device using internal service and third-party service is depicted in accordance with an illustrative

embodiment. Service **302** can be an example for identifying certificates for ports on a device using security manager **214**. In this illustrative example, the same reference numeral may be used in more than one figure. This reuse of a reference numeral in different figures represents the same element in the different figures.

(93) In this illustrative example, service **302** is an internal service that uses security manager **214** to perform internal port scan **256** for device **224** in computer system **306**. In this illustrative example, computer system **306** can include a number of devices such as device **224** in FIG. 2. As depicted, the internal port scan performed by security manager **214** obtains information associated with all active ports that are running on device **224** with only one scan.

(94) In contrast, service **304** is a third-party service that requires authentication to access computer system **308**. In a similar fashion, computer system **308** can include a number of devices such as device **224** in FIG. 2. In this illustrative example, service **304** needs authentication to obtain information associated with active ports running on computer system **308**. In addition, service **304** can only obtain information from a predefined set of active ports running on computer system **308** based on common configurations in system **308**. For example, service **304** can only obtain information associated port **80/443**, information associated port **25**, and information associated port **N** in ports **310** from system **308**.

(95) It should also be understood that illustration of security manager **214** in FIG. 3 is not meant to imply physical or architectural limitations to the manner in which an illustrative embodiment can be implemented. Other components in addition to or in place of the ones illustrated may be used. Some components may be unnecessary. Also, the blocks are presented to illustrate some functional components. One or more of these blocks may be combined, divided, or combined and divided into different blocks when implemented in an illustrative embodiment.

(96) It should also be appreciated that while the illustrative embodiments will be described herein with reference to SSL/TLS as an example network protocol with which the mechanisms of the illustrative embodiments are utilized, the illustrative embodiments are not limited to such. To the contrary, the illustrative embodiments may be implemented and operate with any currently known or later developed network protocol without departing from the spirit and scope of the present invention.

(97) Turning now to FIG. 4, an illustration of a graphical user interface is depicted in accordance with an illustrative embodiment. In this illustrative example, graphical user interface **402** in FIG. 4 can be used to present information included in data structure **222** in FIG. 2.

(98) Graphical user interface **402** shows information associated with a certificate for a device identified using method described in FIG. 2 and FIG. 3. In this illustrative example, location **404** shows the file path for the certificate shown in graphical user interface **402**. As depicted, location **404** is identified by matching content of certificate with content of certificate chains gathered through scanning active ports running on the device. In addition, graphical user interface **402** can also present other information associated with the certificate for the device, as illustrated in metadata **406**. In this illustrative example, metadata **406** can include port number, subject, issuer, encryption method, validation period, status, and any information associated with the certificate for the device.

(99) Turning next to FIG. 5, a dataflow for generating a data structure that includes mapping of certificates and active ports for devices in a network is depicted in accordance with an illustrative embodiment. In this illustrative example, components in FIG. 5 are examples of implementations for security management system **202** in FIG. 2.

(100) In this illustrative example, users **502** can send requests to orchestrator **504** for information associated with certificates and active ports on devices within network **506**. In this illustrative example, users **502** send requests through a frontend user interface to backend webservice in orchestrator **504**. The backend webservice in orchestrator **504** can launch cryptographic software to map all active ports for devices in network **506** to certificates and certificate chains associated with

these active ports. In this illustrative example, the cryptographic software can be an example of security manager **214** in FIG. **2** and the mapping of active ports, certificates, and certificate chains can be performed using method described in FIG. **2**.

(101) In FIG. **5**, mappings of active ports, certificates, and certificate chains for all devices in network **506** are combined together to generate merged results **508**. In this example, merged results **508** can include zero or more of data structures such as data structure **222** in FIG. **2**. As depicted, merged results **508** can be used to perform a number of functions **510**. For example, functions **510** can include certificate management, auditing of records related to the metadata from merged results **508**, network security verification and compliance, and retrieval of information using other cryptographic tools based on merged results **508**.

(102) It should also be understood that illustration in FIG. **5** is not meant to imply physical or architectural limitations to the manner in which an illustrative embodiment can be implemented. Other components in addition to or in place of the ones illustrated may be used. Some components may be unnecessary. Also, the blocks are presented to illustrate some functional components. One or more of these blocks may be combined, divided, or combined and divided into different blocks when implemented in an illustrative embodiment.

(103) Turning next to FIG. **6**, a flowchart of a process for matching certificates with ports on a device is depicted in accordance with an illustrative embodiment. The process in FIG. **6** can be implemented in hardware, software, or both. When implemented in software, the process can take the form of program instructions that are run by one of more processor units located in one or more hardware devices in one or more computer systems. For example, the process can be implemented in security manager **214** in computer system **204** in FIG. **2**.

(104) The process begins by identifying a number of certificates for a device within a network to obtain a file path for each certificate (step **602**). The process performs an internal scan of the device to obtain a port number for each active port associated with network protocol on the device (step **604**). The process identifies a certificate chain associated with each port number based on the network protocol for the device (step **606**).

(105) The process compares content for each certificate from the number of certificates to the certificate chain for the device to generate a number of matches (step **608**). As depicted, the certificate chains include information related to content of certificates for the device. The process can determine whether content for each certificate from the number of certificates can be matched to information related to content of certificates from the certificate chains. In other words, the process determines whether each certificate from the number of certificates is also a certificate that is present in, or encompassing the whole of, the certificate chain.

(106) The process generates a data structure comprising the file path of the certificate for each port on the device based on the number of matches (step **610**). The process terminates thereafter.

(107) It should be understood that the illustrated flowchart is only one embodiment of the present disclosure. The illustration of process in FIG. **6** can also incorporate other features and implementations. For example, the internal scan and identification of the number of certificates can be performed concurrently to improve computation times.

(108) Turning next to FIG. **7**, a flowchart of a process for comparing content of certificate to certificate chains is depicted in accordance with an illustrative embodiment. The process illustrated in FIG. **7** is an example of steps that can be implemented in step **608** in FIG. **6**.

(109) The process begins by selecting a certificate from the number of certificates (step **702**). The process compares blocks from the content of the selected certificate to blocks from content of the certificate chain for each port on the device (step **704**). Blocks from content of certificates and certificate chains refer to sections of encoded data that include public key, issuer detail, validity dates, digital signature, and any relevant metadata.

(110) The process determines whether the content of the selected certificate and the content of the certificate chain for each port on the device originated from same certificate (step **706**). The

process terminates thereafter.

(111) Turning next to FIG. 8, a flowchart of a process for comparing content of certificate to certificate chains is depicted in accordance with an illustrative embodiment. The process illustrated in FIG. 8 is an example of steps that can be implemented in step **704** in FIG. 7.

(112) The process begins by comparing first lines in the blocks from the content of the selected certificate to first lines in the blocks from the content of the certificate chain for each port on the device (step **802**). The process terminates thereafter.

(113) Turning next to FIG. 9, a flowchart of a process for mapping all active ports to file paths of certificates on a device is depicted in accordance with an illustrative embodiment. The process illustrated in FIG. 9 is an additional step that can be performed with the steps in FIG. 6.

(114) The process begins by repeat identifying a certificate chain associated with each port number (step **902**). The process repeats comparing content for each certificate from the number of certificates to the certificate chain for the device to generate a number of matches (step **904**). The process repeats generating the data structure (step **906**). The process determines whether all active ports on the device are mapped to the file paths of certificates (step **908**). In step **908**, if not all active ports on the device are mapped to the file paths of certificates, the process returns to step **902** and repeats step **902** to step **908** until active ports on the device are mapped to the file paths of certificates. On the other hand, if all active ports on the device are mapped to the file paths of certificates, the process terminates thereafter.

(115) The flowcharts and block diagrams in the different depicted embodiments illustrate the architecture, functionality, and operation of some possible implementations of apparatuses and methods in an illustrative embodiment. In this regard, each block in the flowcharts or block diagrams may represent at least one of a module, a segment, a function, or a portion of an operation or step. For example, one or more of the blocks can be implemented as program instructions, hardware, or a combination of the program instructions and hardware. When implemented in hardware, the hardware may, for example, take the form of integrated circuits that are manufactured or configured to perform one or more operations in the flowcharts or block diagrams. When implemented as a combination of program instructions and hardware, the implementation may take the form of firmware. Each block in the flowcharts or the block diagrams can be implemented using special purpose hardware systems that perform the different operations or combinations of special purpose hardware and program instructions run by the special purpose hardware.

(116) In some alternative implementations of an illustrative embodiment, the function or functions noted in the blocks may occur out of the order noted in the figures. For example, in some cases, two blocks shown in succession can be performed substantially concurrently, or the blocks may sometimes be performed in the reverse order, depending upon the functionality involved. Also, other blocks can be added in addition to the illustrated blocks in a flowchart or block diagram.

(117) Turning now to FIG. 10, a block diagram of a data processing system is depicted in accordance with an illustrative embodiment. Data processing system **1000** can be used to implement computers and computing devices in computing environment **100** in FIG. 1. Data processing system **1000** can also be used to implement computer system **204** in FIG. 2. In this illustrative example, data processing system **1000** includes communications framework **1002**, which provides communications between processor unit **1004**, memory **1006**, persistent storage **1008**, communications unit **1010**, input/output (I/O) unit **1012** and display **1014**. In this example, communications framework **1002** takes the form of a bus system.

(118) Processor unit **1004** serves to execute instructions for software that can be loaded into memory **1006**. Processor unit **1004** includes one or more processors. For example, processor unit **1004** can be selected from at least one of a multicore processor, a central processing unit (CPU), a graphics processing unit (GPU), a physics processing unit (PPU), a digital signal processor (DSP), a network processor, or some other suitable type of processor. Further, processor unit **1004** can may

be implemented using one or more heterogeneous processor systems in which a main processor is present with secondary processors on a single chip. As another illustrative example, processor unit **1004** can be a symmetric multi-processor system containing multiple processors of the same type on a single chip.

(119) Memory **1006** and persistent storage **1008** are examples of storage devices **1016**. A storage device is any piece of hardware that is capable of storing information, such as, for example, without limitation, at least one of data, program instructions in functional form, or other suitable information either on a temporary basis, a permanent basis, or both on a temporary basis and a permanent basis. Storage devices **1016** may also be referred to as computer readable storage devices in these illustrative examples. Memory **1006**, in these examples, can be, for example, a random-access memory or any other suitable volatile or non-volatile storage device. Persistent storage **1008** may take various forms, depending on the particular implementation.

(120) For example, persistent storage **1008** may contain one or more components or devices. For example, persistent storage **1008** can be a hard drive, a solid-state drive (SSD), a flash memory, a rewritable optical disk, a rewritable magnetic tape, or some combination of the above. The media used by persistent storage **1008** also can be removable. For example, a removable hard drive can be used for persistent storage **1008**.

(121) Communications unit **1010**, in these illustrative examples, provides for communications with other data processing systems or devices. In these illustrative examples, communications unit **1010** is a network interface card.

(122) Input/output unit **1012** allows for input and output of data with other devices that can be connected to data processing system **1000**. For example, input/output unit **912** may provide a connection for user input through at least one of a keyboard, a mouse, or some other suitable input device. Further, input/output unit **1012** may send output to a printer. Display **1014** provides a mechanism to display information to a user.

(123) Instructions for at least one of the operating system, applications, or programs can be located in storage devices **1016**, which are in communication with processor unit **1004** through communications framework **1002**. The processes of the different embodiments can be performed by processor unit **1004** using computer-implemented instructions, which may be located in a memory, such as memory **1006**.

(124) These instructions are referred to as program instructions, computer usable program instructions, or computer readable program instructions that can be read and executed by a processor in processor unit **1004**. The program instructions in the different embodiments can be embodied on different physical or computer readable storage media, such as memory **1006** or persistent storage **1008**.

(125) Program instructions **1018** are located in a functional form on computer readable media **1020** that is selectively removable and can be loaded onto or transferred to data processing system **1000** for execution by processor unit **1004**. Program instructions **1018** and computer readable media **1020** form computer program product **1022** in these illustrative examples. In the illustrative example, computer readable media **1020** is computer readable storage media **1024**.

(126) Computer readable storage media **1024** is a physical or tangible storage device used to store program instructions **1018** rather than a medium that propagates or transmits program instructions **1018**. Computer readable storage media **1024**, as used herein, is not to be construed as being transitory signals per se, such as radio waves or other freely propagating electromagnetic waves, electromagnetic waves propagating through a waveguide or other transmission media (e.g., light pulses passing through a fiber-optic cable), or electrical signals transmitted through a wire.

(127) Alternatively, program instructions **1018** can be transferred to data processing system **1000** using a computer readable signal media. The computer readable signal media are signals and can be, for example, a propagated data signal containing program instructions **1018**. For example, the computer readable signal media can be at least one of an electromagnetic signal, an optical signal,

or any other suitable type of signal. These signals can be transmitted over connections, such as wireless connections, optical fiber cable, coaxial cable, a wire, or any other suitable type of connection.

(128) Further, as used herein, “computer readable media **1020**” can be singular or plural. For example, program instructions **1018** can be located in computer readable media **1020** in the form of a single storage device or system. In another example, program instructions **1018** can be located in computer readable media **1020** that is distributed in multiple data processing systems. In other words, some instructions in program instructions **1018** can be located in one data processing system while other instructions in program instructions **1018** can be located in one data processing system. For example, a portion of program instructions **1018** can be located in computer readable media **1020** in a server computer while another portion of program instructions **1018** can be located in computer readable media **1020** located in a set of client computers.

(129) The different components illustrated for data processing system **1000** are not meant to provide architectural limitations to the manner in which different embodiments can be implemented. In some illustrative examples, one or more of the components may be incorporated in or otherwise form a portion of, another component. For example, memory **1006**, or portions thereof, may be incorporated in processor unit **1004** in some illustrative examples. The different illustrative embodiments can be implemented in a data processing system including components in addition to or in place of those illustrated for data processing system **1000**. Other components shown in FIG. **10** can be varied from the illustrative examples shown. The different embodiments can be implemented using any hardware device or system capable of running program instructions **1018**.

(130) Thus, illustrative embodiments of the present invention provide a computer implemented method, computer system, and computer program product for selecting applications for processing requests. A number of processor units identify a number of candidate applications for processing requests based on types of application programming interface for each application. The number of processor units validate metadata related to status of applications for each application in the number of candidate applications. The number of processor units select a subgroup of applications from the number of candidate applications to process requests based on the validated metadata. Thus, with the ability to effectively select appropriate applications for processing requests, workload on principal database can be reduced by diverting portions of incoming requests to selected applications such that efficiency for principal database can be improved.

(131) The description of the different illustrative embodiments has been presented for purposes of illustration and description and is not intended to be exhaustive or limited to the embodiments in the form disclosed. The different illustrative examples describe components that perform actions or operations. In an illustrative embodiment, a component can be configured to perform the action or operation described. For example, the component can have a configuration or design for a structure that provides the component an ability to perform the action or operation that is described in the illustrative examples as being performed by the component. Further, to the extent that terms “includes,” “including,” “has”, “contains”, and variants thereof are used herein, such terms are intended to be inclusive in a manner similar to the term “comprises” as an open transition word without precluding any additional or other elements.

(132) The descriptions of the various embodiments of the present invention have been presented for purposes of illustration but are not intended to be exhaustive or limited to the embodiments disclosed. Not all embodiments will include all of the features described in the illustrative examples. Further, different illustrative embodiments may provide different features as compared to other illustrative embodiments. Many modifications and variations will be apparent to those of ordinary skill in the art without departing from the scope and spirit of the described embodiment. The terminology used herein was chosen to best explain the principles of the embodiment, the

practical application or technical improvement over technologies found in the marketplace, or to enable others of ordinary skill in the art to understand the embodiments disclosed here.

Claims

1. A computer implemented method, comprising: identifying, by a number of processor units, a number of certificates for a device within a network to obtain a file path for each certificate; performing, by the number of processor units, an internal scan of the device to obtain a port number for each active port associated with network protocol on the device; identifying, by the number of processor units, a certificate chain associated with each port number based on the network protocol for the device; comparing, by the number of processor units, content for each certificate from the number of certificates to the certificate chains for the device to generate a number of matches; and generating, by the number of processor units, a data structure comprising the file path of the certificate for each port on the device based on the number of matches.
2. The computer implemented method of claim 1, wherein the number of certificates for the device within the network is identified based on file extensions.
3. The computer implemented method of claim 1, wherein the internal scan and identification of the number of certificates are performed concurrently.
4. The computer implemented method of claim 1, wherein comparing, by the number of processor units, content for each certificate from the number of certificates to the certificate chain for the device to generate a number of matches comprises: selecting, by the number of processor units, a certificate from the number of certificates; comparing, by the number of processor units, blocks from the content of the selected certificate to blocks from content of the certificate chain for each port on the device; and determining, by the number of processor units, whether the content of the selected certificate and the content of the certificate chain for each port on the device originated from the same certificate.
5. The computer implemented method of claim 4, wherein comparing, by the number of processor units, content for each certificate from the number of certificates to the certificate chains for the device to generate a number of matches further comprises: comparing, by the number of processor units, first lines in the blocks from the content of the selected certificate to first lines in the blocks from the content of the certificate chain for each port on the device.
6. The computer implemented method of claim 1 further comprising: repeating, by the number of processor units: identifying a certificate chain associated with each port number: comparing content for each certificate from the number of certificates to the certificate chain for the device to generate a number of matches; and generating the data structure; until all active ports on the device are mapped to the file paths of certificates.
7. The computer implemented method of claim 1, wherein the data structure further comprises metadata associated with the certificates based on the number of matches.
8. A computer system comprising: a storage device that stores program instructions; one or more processors operably connected to the storage device and configured to execute the program instructions to cause the system to: identify a number of certificates for a device within a network to obtain a file path for each certificate; perform an internal scan of the device to obtain a port number for each active port associated with network protocol on the device; identify a certificate chain associated with each port number based on the network protocol for the device; compare content for each certificate from the number of certificates to the certificate chains for the device to generate a number of matches; and generate a data structure comprising the file path of the certificate for each port on the device based on the number of matches.
9. The computer system of claim 8, wherein the number of certificates for the device within the network is identified based on file extensions.
10. The computer system of claim 8, wherein the internal scan and identification of the number of

certificates are performed concurrently.

11. The computer system of claim 8, wherein compare content for each certificate from the number of certificates to the certificate chains for the device to generate a number of matches, the number of processor units further executes program instructions to: select a certificate from the number of certificates; compare blocks from the content of the selected certificate to blocks from content of the certificate chain for each port on the device; and determine whether the content of the selected certificate and the content of the certificate chain for each port on the device originated from same certificate.

12. The computer system of claim 11, wherein compare content for each certificate from the number of certificates to the certificate chain for the device to generate a number of matches, the number of processor units further executes program instructions to: compare first lines in the blocks from the content of the selected certificate to first lines in the blocks from the content of the certificate chain for each port on the device.

13. The computer system of claim 8, wherein the number of processor units further executes program instructions to: repeat: identifying a certificate chain associated with each port number: comparing content for each certificate from the number of certificates to the certificate chain for the device to generate a number of matches; and generating the data structure; until all active ports on the device are mapped to the file paths of certificates.

14. The computer system of claim 8, wherein the data structure further comprises metadata associated with the certificates based on the number of matches.

15. A computer program product, the computer program product comprising a computer readable storage medium having program instructions embodied therewith, the program instructions executable by a computer system to cause the computer system to: identify a number of certificates for a device within a network to obtain a file path for each certificate; perform an internal scan of the device to obtain a port number for each active port associated with network protocol on the device; identify a certificate chain associated with each port number based on the network protocol for the device; compare content for each certificate from the number of certificates to the certificate chains for the device to generate a number of matches; and generate a data structure comprising the file path of the certificate for each port on the device based on the number of matches.

16. The computer program product of claim 15, wherein the number of certificates for the device within the network is identified based on file extensions.

17. The computer program product of claim 15, wherein the internal scan and identification of the number of certificates are performed concurrently.

18. The computer program product of claim 15, wherein compare content for each certificate from the number of certificates to the certificate chain for the device to generate a number of matches, the number of processor units further executes program instructions to: select a certificate from the number of certificates; compare blocks from the content of the selected certificate to blocks from content of the certificate chain for each port on the device; and determine whether the content of the selected certificate and the content of the certificate chain for each port on the device originated from same certificate.

19. The computer program product of claim 18, wherein compare content for each certificate from the number of certificates to the certificate chains for the device to generate a number of matches, the number of processor units further executes program instructions to: compare first lines in the blocks from the content of the selected certificate to first lines in the blocks from the content of the certificate chain for each port on the device.

20. The computer program product of claim 15, the number of processor units further executes program instructions to: repeat: identifying a certificate chain associated with each port number: comparing content for each certificate from the number of certificates to the certificate chain for the device to generate a number of matches; and generating the data structure; until all active ports on the device are mapped to the file paths of certificates.

